Which AI Employees To Use in 2026?

References & Companions, Chapter 2/4 — Revision & Viva-Prep Cheatsheet (English + Roman Urdu)
Source: agentfactory.panaversity.org/docs/which-agents-2026

EN: The 5 AI employees used across this book. Choice isn't by ranking -- it's by 'where do I work, where does my data live': work surface (terminal/desktop/messaging) x data home (local/enterprise/chat).
Roman Urdu: Is book mein use hone wale 5 AI employees. Chunaav rank se nahi -- 'main kahan kaam karta hoon, data kahan rehta hai' se: work surface (terminal/desktop/messaging) x data home (local/enterprise/chat).

1. The Two Core Questions + 5 Personas

- Work surface (terminal/desktop/messaging) + data home (local/enterprise/chat) decide the starting point, not a ranking list.
- 5 starting-point rows: developer, domain-expert, executive, PM/architect, security-conscious -- each with its own Day-1 install combo.

2. Fleet Economics + Trade-offs

- Costs: OpenClaw/NanoClaw $15-40/mo API; Claude Code $20/mo sub; Cowork ~$20/mo (same plan runs both); Codex scales with ChatGPT Plus/API.
- NanoClaw is the safest (containerized, no outbound without an explicit grant) -- regulated teams pair it with air-gapped models.
- Qualitative trade-offs: Claude Code is 'chatty' on one-shot tasks, Codex is strong on long-horizon work, OpenClaw needs more prompt-engineering, NanoClaw trades speed for security, Cowork is weak on deep code.

3. Building Your Fleet

- Big picture: General Agents = USE (Mode 1); Personal AI Employees = BUILD AND SELL (Mode 2 territory).
- Migration timeline: Day 1 -> Month 3 -> Month 6, plus beyond-core-fleet alternatives (Gemini CLI, Qwen Code, no-code builders, open-weight models).

Key Terms Cheatsheet

One line each — English + Roman Urdu.

Term	English	Roman Urdu
Work surface x Data home	The 2 questions that decide which AI employee fits, not a ranking.	2 sawal jo decide karte kaunsa AI employee fit karta, ranking nahi.
NanoClaw	The safest option -- containerized, no outbound access without an explicit grant.	Sabse safe option -- containerized, bina explicit grant outbound access nahi.
General Agents vs Personal AI Employees	Use (Mode 1) vs Build and Sell (Mode 2).	Use (Mode 1) vs Build and Sell (Mode 2).
Migration timeline	Day 1 -> Month 3 -> Month 6 fleet growth path.	Day 1 -> Month 3 -> Month 6 fleet growth path.

Quick Self-Check

Question	Answer
What are the 2 core questions that decide which AI employee to use?	Where do you work (work surface: terminal/desktop/messaging), and where does your data live (data home: local/enterprise/chat).
Why is NanoClaw considered the safest option in the fleet?	It runs containerized with no outbound access unless explicitly granted -- a strong fit for regulated teams.
What's the big-picture distinction between General Agents and Personal AI Employees in this book?	General Agents are for USE (Mode 1 work); Personal AI Employees are for BUILD AND SELL (Mode 2 territory).
What's Codex's noted strength compared to Claude Code?	Codex is strong on long-horizon tasks, while Claude Code tends to be 'chatty' on one-shot tasks.

Where This Leads / Sources

Leads to: book-section-to-tool map covers Parts 1-6 (Mode 1 and Mode 2 tool choices). Full 12-Q quiz in 03-test-your-understanding.

Source: docs/which-agents-2026/ (this repo), content originally via Zia Tutor AI connector.